

WildList

Although there are many thousands of known viruses, few actually cause any real-world concern, and those that do are often said to be ‘in the wild’. However, the term ‘in the wild’ has been used in many different contexts and with many different shades of meaning. In an attempt to clear this situation up, for computer viruses, antivirus researcher Joe Wells instigated what he called the WildList. Its purpose was to provide a listing of viruses that could (or should) be considered ‘in the wild’ by set criteria.

Worm

Worms are parasitic computer programs that replicate, but unlike viruses, do not infect other computer program files. Worms can create copies on the same computer, or can send the copies to other computers via a network.

Worm Creation Tool

A program designed to generate worms. Worm creation tools can often generate hundreds or thousands of different, functioning worms, most of which are initially undetectable by current scanners.

Windows Scripting

Windows Scripting Host (WSH) is a Microsoft integrated module that lets programmers use any scripting language to automate operations throughout the Windows desktop.

Zoo

A collection of viruses used for testing by researchers.